# 06-01 第一篇

**The History of Carrier Pigeons**

Long before phones and the Internet, people needed to send messages over long distances. One of the oldest and most reliable methods was using carrier pigeons. [1] These birds have an amazing ability to find their way home from hundreds of kilometers away, even when they have never traveled that path before. Ancient civilizations in Egypt and Rome used pigeons to carry important news during wars and for business.

How do pigeons know where to go? Scientists believe they use several clues. [2] Pigeons can sense the Earth's magnetic field（磁场） and use the position of the sun to guide them. They may also recognize landmarks such as mountains and rivers. This natural gift made them very valuable to armies. During World War I and World War II, pigeons carried thousands of messages when radio signals were not safe or available.

Pigeons saved many lives in wartime. [3] One famous pigeon named Cher Ami flew through enemy fire in 1918 to deliver a message that saved nearly 200 American soldiers. The bird was shot and wounded but still completed its mission. For this bravery, Cher Ami received a medal and became a hero. Many countries trained pigeons for military use because they were fast, quiet, and could fly in bad weather.

After the war, technology slowly replaced pigeons. [4] Radio, telegraph（电报）, and later the telephone made communication faster and easier. By the 1950s, most armies had stopped using carrier pigeons. Today, people mainly keep pigeons as pets or for racing. Pigeon racing is still a popular sport in some countries, where owners train their birds to fly home as quickly as possible.

[5] Carrier pigeons remind us of a time when humans relied on nature's wisdom for communication. They served faithfully for thousands of years and helped shape history. We may no longer need them to send messages, but their story will always be a part of our past.

## 选项

A. In other words, they have a special talent that has been useful to humans for thousands of years. B. That is because they use a combination of natural skills to navigate（导航） and find their way. C. In fact, some pigeons became famous for their courage and were honoured by their countries. D. This meant that pigeons were no longer needed for sending urgent messages. E. In short, these remarkable birds played an important role in human communication throughout history. F. For example, pigeons were often released from ships to carry news back to land.

# 答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

# 深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：引出信鸽的特殊能力与历史悠久。空前描述"people needed to send messages over long distances...using carrier pigeons"，空后说明"These birds have an amazing ability to find their way home from hundreds of kilometers away...Ancient civilizations in Egypt and Rome used pigeons"。A选项"In other words, they have a special talent that has been useful to humans for thousands of years"（换言之，它们具有数千年来对人类有用的特殊才能）中"In other words"概括上文信鸽传信，"special talent"与空后"amazing ability"呼应，"thousands of years"与空后"Ancient civilizations"衔接，逻辑顺畅。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：解释鸽子导航的原理。空前提出"How do pigeons know where to go? Scientists believe they use several clues"，空后列举"Pigeons can sense the Earth's magnetic field...use the position of the sun...recognize landmarks"。B选项"That is because they use a combination of natural skills to navigate and find their way"（那是因为它们运用多种自然技能来导航和认路）中"That is because"回答空前问句，"combination of natural skills"与空后多种线索（磁场、太阳、地标）完美对应，衔接紧密。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：鸽子在战争中立功受奖。空前提出"Pigeons saved many lives in wartime"，空后详述Cher Ami的故事"flew through enemy fire...deliver a message that saved nearly 200...received a medal and became a hero"。C选项"In fact, some pigeons became famous for their courage and were honoured by their countries"（事实上，有些鸽子因其勇气而闻名，并受到国家的表彰）中"In fact"引出具体例证，"famous...courage...honoured"与空后Cher Ami获勋的英雄故事精准呼应，衔接自然。
- **[4] D**：
  - **线索**：技术取代信鸽的必然性。空前描述"After the war, technology slowly replaced pigeons...Radio, telegraph, and later the telephone made communication faster and easier"，空后说明"By the 1950s, most armies had stopped using carrier pigeons"。D选项"This meant that pigeons were no longer needed for sending urgent messages"（这意味着鸽子不再需要用来传递

紧急信息）中"This meant"承接空前技术发展，"no longer needed"与空后"stopped using"形成因果关系，衔接得当。

- **[5] E**：
  - **线索**：全文收束与升华。空[5]位于结尾段段首，空后总结"remind us of a time when humans relied on nature's wisdom...served faithfully for thousands of years...helped shape history...their story will always be a part of our past"。E选项"In short, these remarkable birds played an important role in human communication throughout history"（简言之，这些非凡的鸟类在人类通信史上发挥了重要作用）用"In short"总结全文，"important role...throughout history"与空后"thousands of years...shape history"呼应，收束精准。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example, pigeons were often released from ships to carry news back to land.**：涉及船舰释放鸽子传信的具体场景，易被误填[3]或[1]。但F以"For example"引出船舰用例，而空[3]前后文已聚焦Cher Ami这一具体英雄案例，无需再引入船舰场景；空[1]需要的是对"特殊能力+历史悠久"的概括句，F仅描述用途场景，缺乏"thousands of years"等时间维度。F属"主题相关但衔接功能错位"型干扰。